

1. Definition of Quran and various names of Quran.

Definition of the *Qur'an* Literally:

Scholars of sciences of Quran have differed in Quran whether it is a proper noun or a derivative. Imam Shafiee says it is a proper noun while others say it is a derivative. As a derivative, the Arabic word Qur'an can be derived from the following roots.

Firstly, It can be derived from the root word qara'a (لَسَا) which means to read, to recite. Qur'an is a verbal noun and hence, means the reading or recitation. We get this meaning from the usage of the Qur'an. Qur'an says:

(إِذْ عَزَّيْجُ لَسَا - فَإِذَا لَسَا أَفْجَعِ لَسَا - أَمْيَا - 17 - 18)

"It is for us to collect and to recite it. But when we have recited it, then follow its recitation".

On the basis of this meaning the Quran is called Quran, because it is most widely read book in the world. We read it in prayers, educational institute and many other places for different purposes.

Secondly, it can be derived from the root word qarana (لَسَا) meaning a union or conjunction.

Imam FakrAd Deen Razi quotes Imam Sufyan Souri as stating that the Quran was given its own special name, because letters are joined to make word, words are joined to make surahs and surahs are joined to make Quran.

Some scholars say, the Quran is named with this name, because it combines the substances of previous heavenly books, rather it combines all the branches of knowledge. In this regard

Allah(SWT) says: (إِذَا فَا تَحَابْ شَى - 38)

"Nothing have we omitted from the book".

Thirdly, it can be derived from the root word Qara'in (لَسَا) which is the plural of Qarinah (لَسَا). It means evidence, argument etc. In the Quran, we see that one verse interprets and gives arguments and evidences for another verse. So, Quran is called Quran.

✓ Definition of the *Qur'an* Terminologically: The Quran can be defined as follows:

The speech of Allah, sent down upon the last Prophet Muhammad (SAW), through the angel Gabriel, in its precise meaning and precise wording, transmitted to us by numerous persons (tawatur) both verbally and in writing.

2. The various Names of the *Qur'an*:

The holy Quran has many other names. From these names, some are original some are attributive. The both categories are mentioned in the below:

Original names of the Holy Quran:

- 1) اَلْكِتَاب - Al-Kitab-The Scripture
- 2) اَلْفُرْقَان - Al-Furqan-The Criterion
- 3) اَلذِّكْر - Ad-Dhikr-The Reminder
- 4) اَلْأَنْزِيل - At-Tanzeel_The Revelation

Attributive names of the Holy Quran:

- 1) اَلْبُرْهَان - Al-Burhan-The Proof
- 2) اَلْحَكِيم - Al-Hakeem-The Judicious
- 3) اَلْمَجِيد - Al-Majeed-The Glorious
- 4) اَلْمُبِين - Al-Mubeen-The Perspicuous
- 5) اَلْعَظِيم - Al-Azeem-The Grand
- 6) اَلنُّور - An-Nur-The Light
- 7) اَلْمُهَيْمِن - Al-Muhaimin-The Guard

- 8) (الْحَق)-Al-Haq-The Truth
 - 9) (الْبَأْ)-An-Naba-The Message
 - 10) (الْبَلَاغ)-Al-Balag- The Message
 - 11) (الْمَكْنُون)-Al-Maknoon-The Well guarded
 - 12) (الْكَرِيم)-Al-Kareem-The Honorable
 - 13) (الشِّفَاء)-As-Shifaa-The Healing
 - 14) (الْبُشْرَى)-Al-Bushraa-The Glad tidings
- Mohammad Jaweed iqbal
Assistant Professor of Islamic Studies, CGED,IIUC.
- 15) (الرُّزْءُ الْرَّئِيسُ) Al-Mundhir/An-Nadheer-The Warner
 - 16) (الْبَارَك)-Al-Mubarak-The Blessed
 - 17) (الْهُدَى)-Al-Hudaa-The Guidance
 - 18) (الرَّحْمَةُ)-Ar-Rahmah-The Mercy
 - 19) (الصِّدْق)-Al-Musaddiq-The Confirming